

Infallible Incapable of making mistakes or being wrong

Synonyms Unerring, Flawless

Antonyms Fallible, Erring

- *I never claimed to be infallible.*

Inimical Harmful or limiting

Synonyms Injurious, Harmful

Antonyms Helpful, Advantageous

- *A person with inimical behaviour is dangerous.*

Iniquitous Very unfair or evil

Synonyms Wicked, Sinful

Antonyms Good, Virtuous

- *This decision seems iniquitous.*

Innate (of a quality) which you are born with or which is present naturally

Synonyms Inborn, Ingrained

Antonyms Acquired, Extrinsic

- *He is a person with innate wisdom.*

Insipid Lacking flavour; weak or tasteless

Synonyms Bland, Tasteless

Antonyms Tasty, Delicious

- *The dinner was insipid.*

J

Jabber Talk in a rapid, excited and often incomprehensible way

Synonyms Prattle, Babble

Antonyms Be silent, Speak clearly

- *The train was full of people jabbering into their mobile phones.*

Jaded Not having interest or losing interest as you have experienced something too many times.

Synonyms Bored, Tired

Antonyms Fresh, Activated

- *Flying is exciting the first time you do it, but you soon become jaded.*

Jaunty Lively in manner or appearance

Synonyms Merry, Cheerful

Antonyms Unhappy, Depressed

- *Success makes a person jaunty.*

Jinx Bad luck or a person or thing that brings bad luck

Synonyms Misfortune, Curse

Antonyms Good Luck, Boon

- *His luck has been so bad he feels jinxed.*

Jocular Funny or intended to make someone laugh

Synonyms Funny, Humorous

Antonyms Serious, Depressed

- *Someone made a jocular remark to entertain the gathering.*

K

Kaput Broken; not working properly

Synonyms Faulty, Broken

Antonym Operational

- *My fridge has gone kaput.*

Ken A person's range of knowledge or understanding

Synonyms Knowledge, Awareness

Antonym Ignorance

- *Politics are beyond my ken.*

Kernel The central or most important part of something

Synonyms Essence, Core

Antonyms Exterior, Periphery

- *We are to write the kernel of the story.*

Kindle Arouse or inspire (an emotion or feeling)

Synonyms Arouse, Rouse, Wake

Antonyms Douse, Put out

- *The trip kindled an interest in travel.*

Knave A dishonest man

Synonyms Fraud, Cheat

Antonym Honest

- *A knave cheated me on the bus.*

L

Labile Changing often or easily

Synonyms Adaptable, Reactive

Antonyms Balanced, Unreactive

- *Our culture is the most labile of all.*

Laborious Tedious; needing a lot of time and effort

Synonyms Tough, Arduous

Antonyms Simple, Easy

- *The project needs laborious people.*

Lackadaisical Lacking enthusiasm and determination

Synonyms Lazy, Unenthusiastic

Antonyms Enthusiastic, Excited

- *Efforts from the man seem lackadaisical.*

Laggard A person who makes slow progress and lags behind others

Synonyms Loiterer, Lingerer

Antonym Leader

- *A laggard can't win the race of life.*

Lambaste To criticise severely

Synonyms Chastise, Castigate

Antonyms Praise, Compliment

- *His work was lambasted by everyone.*

Languid Showing or having very little strength, energy or activity.

Synonyms Enervated, Unenergetic

Antonyms Energetic, Active

- *He looked languid after a sleepless night.*

Lassitude A state of physical or mental weariness

Synonyms Fatigue, Lethargy

Antonyms Freshness, Vigour, Energy

- *Symptoms of the disease include paleness and lassitude.*

Leery Cautious or wary due to realistic suspicions

Synonym Careful

Antonym Careless

- *They were leery of their neighbours.*

Leviathan Extremely large and powerful

Synonyms Titan, Huge

Antonyms Powerless, Tiny

- *Shakespeare is the leviathan of English literature.*

Limber (of a person or body part) Able to bend and move easily and smoothly

Synonyms Flexible, Nimble

Antonyms Rigid, Stiff

- *His whole body is a limber of muscles.*

Limpid Clearly expressed and easily understood

Synonyms Lucid, Clear

Antonyms Unclear, Unintelligible

- *The situation is a limpid one to get through.*

- Livid** Extremely angry
 Synonyms Infuriated, Irate
 Antonyms Calm, Peaceful
 • *The boss was livid when yet another deadline was missed.*

M

- Macabre** Horrible, because concerned with death
 Synonyms Shocking, Gruesome
 Antonyms Pleasant, Pleasing
 • *Even the police were horrified at the macabre nature of the killings.*
- Magnanimous** Generous or forgiving
 Synonyms Benevolent, Charitable
 Antonyms Selfish, Mean-spirited
 • *The king was magnanimous towards his subjects.*
- Magnate** Successful businessman; tycoon
 Synonyms Tycoon, Mogul
 Antonyms Pawn, Nobody
 • *Ratan Tata is a business magnate.*
- Maladroit** Awkward in movement or unskilled in behaviour or action
 Synonyms Bumbling, Awkward
 Antonyms Adroit, Skilful
 • *She can be a little maladroit in social situations.*
- Malodorous** Stinking; foul-smelling
 Synonyms Noxious, Fetid
 Antonyms Aromatic, Fragrant
 • *The malodorous drain is a problem for the locality.*
- Maverick** An unorthodox or independent minded person
 Synonyms Non-conformist, Dissenter
 Antonyms Orthodox, Conformist
 • *He was considered as something of a maverick in the publishing word.*
- Mellifluous** Pleasingly smooth and musical to hear
 Synonyms Harmonious, Mellow
 Antonyms Noisy, Cacophonous
 • *She has a rich and mellifluous voice.*
- Mendacious** Not truthful; lying
 Synonyms Deceitful, Dishonest
 Antonyms Truthful, Honest
 • *All his statements are mendacious.*

- Miffed** Annoyed at someone's behaviour towards you
 Synonyms Irritated, Angry
 Antonyms Pleased
 • *The miffed employees called up a strike.*

- Minatory** Expressing or conveying a threat
 Synonyms Aggressive, Threatening
 Antonyms Unthreatening
 • *The minatory situation is under control.*

- Minuscule** Extremely small
 Synonyms Tiny, Minute
 Antonyms Huge, Vast
 • *The minuscule insects are hidden there in the bush.*

- Modicum** A small amount, especially of something good
 Synonyms Particle, Speck
 Antonyms Lot, Entirety
 • *Only a modicum of skill is necessary to put the pieces together.*

- Modish** Fashionable
 Synonym Stylish
 Antonym Traditional
 • *The showroom contains a lot of modish clothes.*

- Mollify** To make someone less angry
 Synonyms Appease, Placate
 Antonyms Enrage, Agitate
 • *All attempts to mollify the extremists have failed.*

- Moor** Wasteland
 Synonyms Upland
 Antonyms Cropland
 • *Government has decided to gentrify the moor.*

N

- Nadir** The worst or lowest point of something
 Synonyms Rock-bottom, Base
 Antonyms Zenith, Apex
 • *He is at the nadir on this matter.*

- Nebulous** (especially of ideas) not clear and having no form
 Synonyms Ambiguous, Vague
 Antonyms Clear, Certain
 • *These philosophical concepts can be nebulous.*

- Nefarious** (especially of activities) morally bad
 Synonyms Heinous, Odious
 Antonyms Delightful, Gentle
 • *The man was found to be involved in nefarious activities.*

- Nettle** To annoy or irritate someone
 Synonyms Irritate, Irk
 Antonyms To please, Calm
 • *His continuous questions nettled him.*

- Niggardly** ungenerous with money, time etc; mean
 Synonyms Mean, Miserly
 Antonyms Generous, Abundant
 • *Rita is a niggardly woman, so don't expect a handout from her.*

- Nihilism** The belief that traditional morals, ideas, beliefs have no worth or value
 Synonyms Negativity, Cynicism
 Antonyms Allowance, Approval
 • *Young generation shows a great deal of nihilistic traditions.*

- Non-plussed** So surprised and confused that one is unsure how to react.
 Synonyms Astonish, Astound
 Antonyms Calm, Comfort
 • *I can't say why he was non-plussed at my arrival.*

O

- Obdurate** Not willing to change your opinion or the way you do something
 Synonyms Adamant, Hardened
 Antonyms Amenable, Submissive
 • *He is known for his obdurate determination.*

- Obfuscate** To make something more difficult to understand
 Synonyms Obscure, Confuse
 Antonyms Clarify, Enlighten
 • *This explanation has obfuscated everybody.*

Obliterate 1. To destroy completely
2. To remove a thought, feeling or memory from someone's mind
Synonyms Demolish, Annihilate
Antonyms Create, Establish
• *An explosion obliterated the new building.*

Obnoxious Very unpleasant or rude
Synonyms Repulsive, Offensive, Disgusting
Antonyms Agreeable, Decent
• *When she's in a bad mood she is obnoxious to everyone.*

Obstinate Unreasonably determined; stubborn
Synonyms Adamant, Inflexible
Antonyms Flexible, Amenable
• *He can be very obstinate at times.*

Obstreperous Difficult to deal with and noisy
Synonyms Unruly, Boisterous
Antonyms Pacified, Tractable
• *The executive refused to help the obstreperous clientele.*

Obverse Opposite or counterpart of a fact or truth
Synonyms Complement, Counterpart
Antonyms Reverse, Rear
• *The two brothers are of obverse nature.*

Obviate Remove (a need or difficulty); avoid or prevent something undesirable
Synonyms Remove, Prevent
Antonyms Support, Allow
• *A parachute can be used to obviate disaster.*

Occult Relating to magical powers and activities
Synonyms Psychic, Magical
Antonyms Natural, Obvious
• *Some books in the library were on occult subjects.*

Offbeat Unusual and strange therefore surprising or noticeable
Synonyms Bizarre, Unconventional
Antonyms Ordinary, Conventional
• *She decided to choose an offbeat career in fine arts and was successful.*

Onerous Difficult to do or needing a lot of effort
Synonyms Arduous, Demanding
Antonyms Effortless, Easy
• *She found the duties of motherhood onerous.*

Overweening Too proud or confident in yourself
Synonyms Brash, Haughty
Antonyms Modest, Unassuming
• *Nobody wants to be friendly with overweening people.*

Overwrought In a state of being upset, nervous and worried
Synonyms Frantic, Agitated and Worried
Antonyms Calm, Collected
• *He was in an overwrought state for weeks after the accident.*



Palliate To reduce the bad effects of something; To reduce pain without curing its cause
Synonyms Alleviate, Soothe
Antonyms Aggravate, Agitate
• *The medicine palliated the pain of the patient*

Pallid 1. Very pale, in a way that looks unhealthy and not attractive
2. Showing no enthusiasm or excitement
Synonyms Anemic, Feeble, Uninspired
Antonyms Enthusiastic, Hearty, Strong
• *His pallid face reveals the tension.*

Pandemonium Wild and noisy disorder or confusion
Synonyms Disorder, Chaos
Antonyms Calm, Order
• *Pandemonium reigned in the hall as the election results were announced.*

Parched Dried out because of too much heat.
Synonyms Arid, Scorched
Antonyms Wet, Damp
• *It was the height of summer and the land was parched and brown.*

Parlous Very bad, dangerous or uncertain
Synonyms Bad, Dreadful
Antonyms Good, Comfortable
• *Relationship between the two countries have been in a parlous state for some time.*

Parsimonious Very unwilling to spend money or give something; stingy
Synonyms Niggardly, Miserly
Antonyms Extravagant, Generous
• *Even the parsimonious Deepu went to the cafe.*

Paucity The fact that there is too little of something
Synonyms Shortage, Dearth
Antonyms Abundance, Sufficiency
• *Wastage of water can cause its paucity.*

Pejorative Expressing disapproval or suggesting that something is not good or is of no importance
Synonyms Disparaging, Deprecatory
Antonyms Complimentary, Praising
• *Make sure students realise that 'fat' is a pejorative word.*

Pellucid Very clear in meaning and easy to understand
Synonyms Comprehensible, Understandable
Antonyms Complex, Unclear
• *The pellucid language of the book catches the attention of everyone.*

Perky Cheerful and lively
Synonyms Bubbly, Lively
Antonyms Depressed, Gloomy
• *His perky face looks elegant to me.*

Pesky Causing trouble; Annoying
Synonyms Nettlesome, Troublesome
Antonyms Pleasing, Untroubling
• *I've been trying to get rid of this pesky cold.*

Plaudits Enthusiastic approval; praise
Synonyms Accolade, Acclaim
Antonyms Blame, Censure
• *She has received plaudits for her work with homeless people.*

Plenary 1. Complete; full
 2. (of a meeting) To be attended by all participants, who otherwise meet in smaller groups
 Synonyms Absolute, Complete
 Antonyms Incomplete, Limited
 • A plenary session of the UN Security Council was held this month.

Predicament A difficult, unpleasant or embarrassing situation
 Synonyms Crisis, Deadlock
 Antonyms Advantage, Solution
 • I have taken a loan to get out of my financial predicament.

Prevaricate To avoid telling the truth or saying exactly what you think about something
 Synonyms Distort, Dodge
 Antonyms Confront, Face
 • The convict prevaricated before the court.

Proclivity A strong natural liking for something or tendency to do something that is usually bad.
 Synonyms Predilection, Predisposition
 Antonyms Antipathy, Disinclination
 • Gambling is his main proclivity.

Profligate Wasteful with money and resources
 Synonyms Extravagant, Wasteful
 Antonyms Thrifty, Frugal
 • She is well-known for her profligate spending habits.

Q

Quagmire 1. An area of soft wet ground which one sinks into if one tries and walks on it.
 2. An awkward, complex or hazardous situation.
 Synonyms Dilemma, Entanglement
 Antonyms Solution, Agreement
 • The quagmire he is in seems unavoidable.

Quail Feel or show fear or apprehension
 Synonyms Blanch, Cringe
 Antonyms Calm, Steady
 • Students were quailing before the principal.

Quaint Attractive because of being unusual and especially old-fashioned
 Synonym Bizarre
 Antonym Common
 • The writer talked about the quaint customs of the natives.

Quandary A state of not being able to decide what to do about a situation in which you are involved.
 Synonyms Impasse, Difficulty
 Antonyms Solution, Certainty
 • The unexpected results of the test have created a quandary for the researchers.

Querulous Complaining in an annoyed way.
 Synonyms Petulant, Bemoaning
 Antonyms Cheerful, Easy-going
 • He is becoming a querulous person day by day.

Quibble To argue or complain about small, unimportant things
 Synonyms Protest, Argument
 Antonyms Approval, Agreement
 • There is no point quibbling over a couple of dollars.

Quip A humorous and clever remark
 Synonyms Gag, Gibe
 Antonyms Seriousness, Praise
 • They traded quips over a beer.

Quisling A person who helps an enemy who has taken over his country.
 Synonyms Collaborator, Betrayer
 Antonyms Supporter, Loyalist
 • The ruler warned all the quislings.

Quixotic Having ideas or intentions that are impressive but not practical.
 Synonyms Impractical, Idealistic
 Antonyms Practical, Pragmatic
 • They had quixotic dreams about future.

R

Rabid Having a very extreme opinion about or interest in something
 Synonyms Crazy, Fanatical
 Antonyms Moderate, Liberal
 • Amit is a rabid cricket fan.

Rankle To make someone annoyed or angry for a long time
 Synonyms Anger, Embitter
 Antonyms Calm, Comfort
 • It still rankles me that she got promoted and I didn't.

Raspy Unpleasantly rough
 Synonyms Gruff, Hoarse
 Antonyms Soothing, Soft
 • Her voice was raspy due to yelling so much.

Ratify To make a treaty, agreement etc official by signing it or voting for it.
 Synonyms Sanction, Approve
 Antonyms Disapprove, Deny
 • Project was ratified by the officials.

Ravishing Very beautiful
 Synonyms Gorgeous, Stunning
 Antonyms Ugly, Hideous
 • She looked ravishing in her wedding dress.

Recondite (of a subject or knowledge) Not known by many people and difficult to understand
 Synonyms Obscure, Esoteric
 Antonyms Obvious, Simple
 • Geochemistry is a recondite subject.

Recoup To get back money that one has spent or lost
 Synonyms Retrieve, Regain
 Antonyms Forefeit, Lose
 • The gambler recouped his losses in the next game.

Rectitude The quality of being honest and morally correct
 Synonyms Righteousness, Goodness
 Antonyms Infamy, Dishonesty
 • Gandhi was a man of unquestioned moral rectitude.

Redolent Strongly reminiscent or suggestive of; fragrant; odorous; suggestive of an odour
 Synonyms Evocative, Suggestive
 Antonyms Bland, Unsavoury
 • Rashi's house seemed to be redolent with the aroma of flowers.

Reek (v/n) To smell strongly and unpleasantly; stink
 Synonyms Stink, Smell
 Antonyms Sweetness, Fragrance
 • Her breath reeked of garlic.

Renunciation The formal rejection of something, typically a belief, claim or course of action

Synonyms Repudiation, Abandonment

Antonyms Agreement, Allowance

- *The company renounced the agreement made by them.*

Repartee Conversation or speech characterised by quick, witty comments or replies

Synonyms Banter, Pleasantry

Antonyms Seriousness, Question

- *The two comedians engaged in witty repartee.*

Replete Filled or well supplied with something

Synonyms Filled, Loaded

Antonyms Lacking, Empty

- *The book is replete with photographs.*

Reprieve To cancel or postpone a punishment

Synonyms Abatement, Absolution

Antonyms Charge, Punish

- *He was sentenced to death but was granted a last minute reprieve.*

Reproach To criticise someone, especially for not being successful or not doing what is expected

Synonyms Disgrace, Rebuke

Antonyms Approval, Commendation

- *His mother reproached him for not eating his dinner.*

Repugnant Causing a strong feeling of dislike or disgust

Synonyms Repulsive, Abhorrent

Antonyms Pleasant, Delightful

- *The idea of cheating in an exam is morally repugnant to me.*



Scintillate Emit flashes of light, sparkle

Synonyms Shine, Gleam

Antonym Dull

- *Her scintillating performance on stage won her accolades.*

Scoff To laugh and speak about a person or idea in a way that shows you think they are silly or stupid.

Synonyms Belittle, Deride

Antonyms Approve, Compliment

- *The critics scoffed at his paintings.*

Sententious Trying to appear wise, clever and important in a way that is annoying

Synonyms Moralistic, Self-righteous

Antonym Unimportant

- *Due to his sententious and pompous way of speaking, he respected by none.*

Servitude The state of being under the control of someone else and of having no freedom; slavery

Synonyms Bondage, Enslavement

Antonyms Freedom, Mastery

- *In the past, the majority of women were confined to a lifetime of servitude and poverty.*

Sever To put an end to (a connection or relationship); break off

Synonyms Detach, Disconnect

Antonyms Unite, Connect

- *I severed myself from my double-faced friends.*

Sham Someone or something that is not what it pretends to be; pretence

Synonyms Fake, Pretend

Antonyms Real, Genuine

- *They claimed that the election had been fair, but really it was a sham.*

Skulduggery Secret and dishonest behaviour

Synonyms Trickery, Fraudulence

Antonym Honesty

- *Skulduggery is never appreciated.*

Sleaze Activities especially business or political, of a low moral standard

Synonyms Corrupt, Immoral

Antonyms Moral, Principled

- *Molestation is an obvious sleaze.*

Slipshod Characterised by a lack of care, thought or organisation; shabby

Synonyms Careless, Disorganised

Antonyms Careful, Meticulous

- *She complained that the carpenter's work had been slipshod.*

Slovenly 1. Untidy and dirty
2. (of a person or action) careless; excessively casual

Synonyms Messy, Scruffy

Antonyms Tidy, Neat

- *Change your slovenly habits right now.*

Stalwart 1. Loyal, reliable and hardworking

Synonyms Staunch, Dependable

Antonyms Non-reliable, Undependable

- *I have a bunch of stalwart friends.*

Stodgy Dull and uninspired; lacking originality or excitement

Synonyms Boring, Dull

Antonyms Interesting, Lively

- *The company did not succeed in shedding its stodgy image.*

Stouthearted Brave and determined

Synonyms Fearless, Courageous

Antonyms Timid, Cowardly

- *The stouthearted soldiers won the battle.*

Stupor A state of near- unconsciousness or insensibility

Synonyms Coma, Trance

Antonyms Consciousness, Wakefulness

- *He was lying under a table in a drunken stupor.*



Taint To damage something, especially by adding something harmful or undesirable to it

Synonyms Contaminate, Pollute

Antonyms Clean, Improve

- *A leaky pipe can taint the entire water supply.*

Tangible Real or not imaginary; able to be shown, touched or experienced

Synonyms Palpable, Touchable

Antonyms Intangible, Abstract

- *There is no tangible evidence to support her claim.*

Thrifty Using money and other resources carefully and not wastefully

Synonyms Frugal, Prudent

Antonyms Extravagant, Generous

- *He is being thrifty in deciding his budget.*